

DEPARTMENT OF JUSTICE ACCREDITED REPRESENTATIVE POSITION DESCRIPTION

Organization: Immigrant Connection PDX

Position: Department of Justice Accredited Representative

Reports To: Site Director

Accreditation Level: Partial Accreditation

Compensation: DOE

Position Hours: FTE (32 - 40 hours/week)

About Immigrant Connection PDX

Immigrant Connection PDX (ICPDX) is a Department of Justice-recognized, church-based nonprofit providing affordable, high-quality immigration legal services to under-resourced communities in East Portland and beyond. Since opening in 2020, we have served over 1,500 individuals from more than 65 countries, submitting nearly 500 immigration cases with a 99% approval rate.

Located in the Rockwood neighborhood - one of Oregon's most diverse and underserved areas - ICPDX offers culturally competent legal services in English & Spanish. Our services encompass a wide range of immigration case types, such as family and marriage-based petitions, naturalization, DACA, TPS, work authorization, and more.

As part of The Immigrant Connection National Network, which has served over 40,000 immigrant families across 35 DOJ-recognized sites in 23 states, ICPDX is committed to walking alongside our clients with compassion, expertise, and integrity. Our mission is to build bridges for a hope-filled future, empowering immigrants to navigate the complex legal system and achieve stability, opportunity, and family reunification.

POSITION OVERVIEW

The Department of Justice (DOJ) Accredited Representative provides competent, ethical, client-centered immigration legal services through Immigrant Connection PDX as a DOJ Recognized Organization. This position assumes the candidate already has received their partial DOJ accreditation, or if not, would follow ICPDX's training program to move towards partial accreditation.

The Accredited Representative is responsible for evaluating immigration matters, conducting legal consultations and screenings, identifying potential immigration benefits and legal risks, developing appropriate case strategies, advising clients regarding available options, preparing and reviewing immigration filings, representing clients before authorized government agencies within the scope of the representative's accreditation, and ensuring that matters accepted by the organization are handled accurately, diligently, and professionally.

In short, The Accredited Representative bears responsibility for the legal analysis, legal advice, case strategy, final review, representation, and professional judgment associated with practicing family-based immigration law.

The Accredited Representative also provides appropriate direction and supervision to Legal Assistants and other support staff involved in case preparation. The representative is expected to delegate administrative and preparatory work appropriately while personally maintaining sufficient knowledge of each case to competently advise the client and take responsibility for the legal work performed under their supervision.

All immigration legal services must be provided through Immigrant Connection PDX and within the scope of the representative's current DOJ accreditation (in this case, partial accreditation) organizational policies, applicable law, professional conduct requirements, and demonstrated competence.

PRIMARY OBJECTIVE

Provide high-quality immigration legal representation that is:

- Legally sound.
- Accurate and thoroughly prepared.
- Timely and well-managed.
- Clearly communicated to clients.
- Properly documented.
- Consistent with applicable immigration law and procedure.
- Within the representative's authorized scope and competence.
- Compassionate and respectful toward clients.
- Protective of the integrity and reputation of Immigrant Connection PDX.

1. LEGAL CONSULTATIONS, SCREENING & ISSUE IDENTIFICATION

The Accredited Representative is responsible for conducting effective consultations and legal screenings that identify the client's immigration history, objectives, eligibility, potential legal issues, and appropriate next steps.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Conduct immigration consultations and screenings within the representative's approved scope of practice.
- Gather a complete and accurate factual history relevant to the client's immigration matter.
- Ask appropriate follow-up questions rather than relying exclusively on information volunteered by the client or entered on an intake form.
- Identify facts that may materially affect eligibility or strategy.

- Review relevant immigration history, entries, exits, status, prior applications, petitions, encounters with immigration authorities, and removal proceedings when applicable.
- Identify relevant family, marital, criminal, employment, residence, travel, and other histories as appropriate to the matter.
- Recognize inconsistencies, missing information, unusual facts, or potential legal concerns requiring additional investigation.
- Determine when additional documents, records, FOIA requests, court dispositions, immigration records, or other evidence are needed before legal advice can responsibly be given.
- Distinguish between facts that are legally significant and information that is peripheral to the legal analysis.
- Explain when the organization cannot yet provide a definitive recommendation because additional facts or records are required.
- Identify matters outside the representative's authorized scope, experience, or competence and refer or consult appropriately.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- Consultations consistently produce enough reliable information to make a reasoned legal assessment or clearly identify what additional information is required.
- Important legal facts are discovered through thoughtful questioning rather than being missed because they were not volunteered by the client.
- Potential risks, complications, inadmissibility concerns, immigration violations, criminal issues, prior filings, or procedural problems are recognized early.
- Case notes clearly document the relevant facts, legal issues, advice provided, and next steps.
- The representative does not give premature or unsupported legal advice when necessary information is missing.
- Matters requiring greater expertise are recognized and escalated before the organization or client is placed at unnecessary risk.

2. LEGAL ANALYSIS, ELIGIBILITY & CASE STRATEGY

The Accredited Representative is responsible for determining whether a client's circumstances support a particular immigration benefit or legal course of action and for developing an appropriate strategy for submitting an immigration petition to the government.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Analyze client facts under applicable immigration law, regulations, policies, agency guidance, and current procedures.
- Determine potential eligibility for immigration benefits.
- Identify legal risks, weaknesses, possible bars, discretionary concerns, procedural obstacles, and alternative options.
- Distinguish between straightforward matters and cases requiring additional research, consultation, or referral.

- Conduct appropriate legal research when the answer is not sufficiently clear from existing knowledge and established organizational resources.
- Review current law, form instructions, policy guidance, and procedural requirements rather than relying on outdated practices or assumptions.
- Develop a clear strategy for cases the organization accepts.
- Determine whether filing is legally appropriate and in the client's interests based on the information reasonably available.
- Reevaluate strategy when new information, evidence, agency action, or changes in law affect the case.
- Clearly document significant legal conclusions and strategic decisions in the case record.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- Cases are accepted because the representative has identified a reasonable legal basis for proceeding - not simply because the client requests a particular application.
- The representative can clearly explain why the client appears eligible, what unresolved risks exist, and why the recommended strategy is appropriate.
- Legal conclusions are grounded in current law and procedure.
- Complex or unfamiliar issues prompt research or consultation rather than guesswork.
- Significant risks are identified before filing whenever reasonably possible.
- Case strategy is revisited when circumstances change instead of continuing automatically with an outdated plan.

3. LEGAL ADVICE & CLIENT COUNSELING

The Accredited Representative is responsible for providing clients with understandable, accurate, and appropriately qualified legal advice so clients can make informed decisions regarding their immigration matters.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Explain immigration options, requirements, risks, responsibilities, and anticipated next steps in understandable language.
- Explain significant strengths and weaknesses of a proposed case.
- Clearly distinguish between what is known, what is uncertain, and what depends upon government discretion or future developments.
- Avoid guaranteeing outcomes, processing times, approvals, or government action.
- Explain foreseeable consequences associated with filing or declining to file when relevant.
- Discuss alternative legal options when appropriate.
- Ensure clients understand significant information contained in documents they are asked to sign.
- Obtain informed client decisions regarding significant strategic choices.
- Correct client misunderstandings regarding immigration law or government procedures.
- Communicate difficult or unfavorable information truthfully and compassionately.

- Use qualified interpreters or appropriate language resources when necessary to ensure meaningful communication.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- Clients leave significant appointments understanding what the organization recommends, why it recommends it, what risks exist, and what they are responsible for doing next.
- Clients are not surprised by foreseeable requirements or risks that should reasonably have been explained beforehand.
- The representative communicates uncertainty accurately rather than overstating confidence.
- Case notes document important advice and client decisions.
- Difficult information is communicated clearly without unnecessarily alarming or misleading the client.
- Clients are treated as informed participants in their case rather than passive recipients of paperwork.

4. CASE OWNERSHIP, MANAGEMENT & FOLLOW-THROUGH

The Accredited Representative owns the legal progression of assigned cases from consultation or acceptance through completion, closure, transfer, or appropriate referral.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Understand the current status of assigned cases and the next meaningful action required.
- Establish and maintain an appropriate case plan.
- Track relevant deadlines, expiration dates, response periods, appointments, interview dates, biometrics requirements, RFEs, NOIDs, agency correspondence, and other case milestones.
- Assign appropriate preparatory tasks to Legal Assistants while retaining responsibility for the legal matter.
- Review completed tasks and ensure that necessary follow-up occurs.
- Respond appropriately to changes in a client's circumstances.
- Ensure client communications requiring legal attention are addressed within reasonable timeframes.
- Determine when dormant cases require client contact, closure, additional action, or reassessment.
- Follow matters through to a clear conclusion consistent with the agreed scope of representation.
- Document significant developments and case decisions in the established case-management system.
- Ensure files accurately reflect the case's current status.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- The representative can quickly identify where assigned cases stand and what needs to happen next.
- Deadlines and critical case events do not depend solely on a client, Legal Assistant, or supervisor reminding the representative.
- Cases continue progressing without unnecessary periods of inactivity caused by internal oversight.
- Delegated work is reviewed and incorporated into the larger case strategy.
- Government correspondence results in timely and appropriate action.
- Matters are formally concluded, transferred, or closed rather than remaining indefinitely unresolved.

5. APPLICATION, PETITION & FILING QUALITY

The Accredited Representative is ultimately responsible for ensuring immigration filings prepared under their direction are accurate, complete, legally appropriate, internally consistent, and ready for submission.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Review all substantive forms and filings before client signature and submission.
- Confirm that the filing reflects the legal strategy approved for the case.
- Compare forms against client questionnaires, consultations, supporting documents, prior filings, and available immigration records.
- Identify inconsistencies between forms or between the filing and documentary evidence.
- Verify material biographical and historical information.
- Ensure relevant immigration, residence, employment, marital, travel, criminal, and other histories are complete when required.
- Confirm that required supporting evidence is included.
- Evaluate whether supporting documents are legally sufficient and appropriate.
- Ensure required translations and certifications are present when applicable.
- Verify that current editions of forms and current filing requirements are being used.
- Confirm filing fees, fee-waiver requests, filing locations, signature requirements, photographs, medical examinations, or other procedural requirements as applicable.
- Ensure client-requested or representative-requested corrections have actually been incorporated.
- Review final filing packages sufficiently in advance to prevent avoidable signing-day emergencies.
- Ensure the client has a reasonable opportunity to review significant information before signing.
- Confirm that submitted filings and associated records are preserved in the case-management system according to office procedures.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- Filings reach final signing substantially complete and ready for client review rather than requiring extensive reconstruction at the appointment.
- Forms accurately reflect information provided by the client and contained in supporting records.
- Contradictions, unanswered questions, missing pages, outdated forms, incorrect fees, missing signatures, or absent supporting documents are ordinarily caught internally before submission.
- The representative's review adds substantive legal quality control rather than functioning as a quick administrative approval.
- Preventable errors decline because patterns are identified and corrected at both the individual-case and office-process levels.
- The representative is comfortable placing their name and professional responsibility behind every filing they approve.

6. GOVERNMENT CORRESPONDENCE, RFES, NOIDs & ADVERSE DEVELOPMENTS

The Accredited Representative is responsible for evaluating and responding appropriately to government notices and developments affecting assigned cases.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Review USCIS, DHS, EOIR, Department of State, or other relevant government correspondence promptly within the scope of accreditation and representation.
- Identify the legal and procedural significance of notices received.
- Determine applicable response deadlines.
- Analyze Requests for Evidence, Notices of Intent to Deny, denials, rejections, interview notices, biometrics notices, and other agency communications.
- Develop an appropriate response strategy.
- Explain significant developments to the client and identify what information or evidence is required from them.
- Delegate evidence collection and administrative preparation where appropriate.
- Personally review substantive responses before filing.
- Conduct legal research or obtain consultation when an adverse development raises unfamiliar or complex issues.
- Evaluate whether reconsideration, appeal, refiling, referral, or another legal response may be appropriate.
- Document the decision and next steps.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- Government notices receive timely legal review rather than simply being uploaded or forwarded.
- Response deadlines are identified immediately and managed intentionally.

- Responses address the actual legal or evidentiary concerns raised by the agency.
- Clients receive clear instructions regarding what is needed and when.
- Adverse decisions trigger legal evaluation rather than an automatic assumption that nothing further can be done.
- Matters outside the representative's competence or accreditation are promptly referred or escalated.

7. CLIENT REPRESENTATION & ADVOCACY

The Accredited Representative serves as the client's authorized immigration representative within the limits of their accreditation, organizational authorization, and scope of representation.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Enter appearances when appropriate and authorized.
- Communicate with government agencies on behalf of clients when permitted.
- Prepare clients for interviews, appointments, hearings, or other proceedings within the representative's authorized scope.
- Attend USCIS interviews or other authorized proceedings when representation is appropriate and within organizational practice.
- Advocate professionally for the client's lawful interests.
- Present relevant legal arguments and evidence accurately and respectfully.
- Correct misunderstandings or factual inaccuracies when appropriate.
- Maintain familiarity with applicable procedural expectations for appearances.
- Protect client confidentiality and privileged or protected information as applicable.
- Maintain professional independence and avoid allowing outside pressure to compromise legal judgment.
- Accurately identify themselves as a DOJ Accredited Representative and never misrepresent themselves as an attorney.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- Clients are prepared for government interactions and understand what to expect.
- The representative is familiar with the case before appearing on the client's behalf.
- Advocacy is calm, professional, legally grounded, and client-centered.
- Government officials receive accurate information and organized documentation.
- The representative remains within the permitted scope of accreditation at all times.

Scope Note: A partially accredited representative may represent clients before DHS, including USCIS. Representation before immigration courts or the Board of Immigration Appeals requires full accreditation, and thus is outside the scope and practice of Immigrant Connection PDX.

8. SUPERVISION, DELEGATION & DEVELOPMENT OF LEGAL ASSISTANTS

The Accredited Representative is responsible for appropriately supervising legal work delegated to Legal Assistants and ensuring that support staff operate within their authorized role.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Clearly communicate assigned tasks, deadlines, and expected outcomes.
- Delegate administrative and case-preparation responsibilities appropriately.
- Ensure Legal Assistants understand the workflow and purpose of delegated tasks.
- Remain available for appropriate legal questions and escalation.
- Review work requiring representative approval before it reaches the client or government.
- Provide timely and specific corrective feedback.
- Help Legal Assistants understand recurring case workflows so they can increasingly anticipate appropriate administrative next steps.
- Distinguish between tasks Legal Assistants may appropriately perform and legal advice or judgment reserved for authorized practitioners.
- Intervene when a Legal Assistant encounters facts requiring legal analysis.
- Identify recurring errors and provide training or process improvements where necessary.
- Maintain accountability for the legal work product even when portions of preparation have been delegated.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- Legal Assistants understand both what they are being asked to do and what legal questions must be brought back to the representative.
- Delegation increases office capacity without lowering legal quality.
- Staff receive enough direction to succeed without unnecessary micromanagement.
- Problems are corrected constructively and patterns are addressed rather than repeatedly fixed one case at a time.
- Legal Assistants do not independently provide unauthorized legal advice.
- The representative does not treat delegation as transferring responsibility for the legal case.

9. DOCUMENTATION & CASE NOTES

The Accredited Representative is responsible for maintaining case documentation that allows the organization to understand what occurred, what legal advice was provided, what decisions were made, and what must happen next.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will document:

- Significant facts obtained during consultations and appointments.
- Material legal issues identified.
- Legal advice and recommendations provided.
- Risks or concerns discussed with the client.
- Significant client decisions.
- Case strategy and changes to strategy.
- Important communication with clients or government agencies.
- Outstanding evidence or information.
- Assigned tasks and next steps.
- Government notices and resulting action.
- Reasons for significant case decisions when appropriate.
- Referral, withdrawal, termination, transfer, or closure of representation.

Case notes should be sufficiently detailed to allow another qualified representative to understand the matter without requiring reconstruction from memory.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- Another representative reviewing the file can understand the client's situation, advice previously given, current strategy, outstanding issues, and next steps.
- Important legal advice is not dependent upon the representative's memory.
- Case notes distinguish facts from legal conclusions where appropriate.
- Documentation is completed promptly enough to remain reliable.
- Significant client decisions and warnings are preserved in the record.

10. RELIABILITY, ACCOUNTABILITY & PROFESSIONAL DILIGENCE

The Accredited Representative is entrusted with legal matters that may significantly affect clients and their families. The position therefore requires a high level of personal reliability and professional diligence.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Complete assigned responsibilities fully and within reasonable or required deadlines.
- Maintain an effective method for tracking obligations.
- Follow through on commitments made to clients, staff, supervisors, and government agencies.
- Communicate promptly when a responsibility cannot be completed as expected.
- Manage workload so accepted matters can be handled competently.
- Seek assistance when workload, complexity, or circumstances threaten the quality or timeliness of representation.
- Avoid allowing cases to become urgent because of preventable internal delay.
- Maintain reasonable availability to address time-sensitive matters.
- Accept responsibility for errors and participate constructively in correcting them.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- Supervisors can trust that assigned legal matters are being actively managed without needing to repeatedly check whether basic steps were completed.
- Clients receive promised follow-up within reasonable timeframes.
- Workload concerns are communicated before deadlines or service quality are compromised.
- Mistakes result in prompt disclosure, correction, and improved processes rather than concealment or defensiveness.
- Important responsibilities are tracked systematically rather than through memory alone.

11. FOCUS, PRODUCTIVITY & TIME MANAGEMENT

The Accredited Representative is responsible for using work time effectively while balancing consultations, case preparation, legal research, client communication, staff supervision, government correspondence, and organizational responsibilities.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Prioritize matters according to legal urgency, deadlines, client needs, and organizational priorities.
- Maintain focus during consultations, case review, research, staff supervision, and client appointments.
- Schedule sufficient uninterrupted time for substantive legal work.
- Balance immediate client needs with longer-term case preparation.
- Maintain measurable progress on assigned caseload.
- Avoid unnecessary delays in reviewing work submitted by Legal Assistants.
- Manage personal distractions appropriately during working hours.
- Communicate when workload exceeds reasonable capacity.
- Participate in office planning intended to distribute caseload effectively.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- Urgent matters receive prompt attention without routine cases becoming unnecessarily neglected.
- Legal Assistants are not routinely waiting extended periods for representative review before cases can move forward.
- The representative's calendar and work habits provide adequate time for both client-facing and substantive legal responsibilities.
- Cases demonstrate steady progress.
- The representative knows when workload has become excessive and seeks adjustment before representation suffers.

12. COMMUNICATION & TEAMWORK

The Accredited Representative functions as both a legal practitioner and a member of the Immigrant Connection PDX team.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Communicate clearly, respectfully, and professionally with clients, coworkers, supervisors, volunteers, partner organizations, and government personnel.
- Communicate relevant case developments to appropriate staff.
- Provide clear instructions when delegating work.
- Listen carefully to staff questions and client concerns.
- Participate constructively in case-review conversations.
- Ask for consultation when another representative or attorney's perspective would strengthen legal decision-making.
- Give and receive professional feedback appropriately.
- Address disagreement directly and respectfully.
- Communicate schedule changes, absences, or other circumstances affecting client services.
- Support collaborative rather than siloed case management.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- Staff understand the representative's instructions and priorities.
- Important information is shared with the people who need it.
- Legal disagreements can be discussed professionally without damaging team relationships.
- The representative both contributes expertise and remains willing to learn from others.
- Clients experience the office as coordinated rather than receiving contradictory information from different staff members.

13. PROFESSIONAL ETHICS, CONFIDENTIALITY & CLIENT PROTECTION

The Accredited Representative is expected to demonstrate the ethical judgment appropriate to a practitioner entrusted with confidential client information and significant legal matters.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Follow applicable DOJ professional conduct requirements and organizational ethical standards.
- Maintain client confidentiality.
- Protect client records and personally identifiable information.
- Avoid conflicts of interest and promptly identify potential conflicts for review.
- Provide truthful information to clients, government agencies, supervisors, and the organization.

- Never knowingly submit false or misleading information.
- Never encourage or assist a client in providing false information or concealing material facts.
- Clearly explain the limits of representation.
- Respect the client's authority to make decisions assigned to the client after receiving appropriate legal advice.
- Avoid guarantees or misleading statements regarding outcomes.
- Maintain appropriate professional boundaries.
- Avoid unauthorized practice outside the representative's accreditation or organizational authorization.
- Identify and disclose mistakes affecting a client's matter so corrective action can be evaluated.
- Protect original documents and sensitive client information entrusted to the organization.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- The representative's conduct consistently protects the client's interests while preserving the integrity of the organization and immigration legal system.
- Ethical concerns are raised early instead of being ignored because addressing them may be uncomfortable.
- Clients receive truthful advice even when the answer is disappointing.
- Confidential information is shared only when appropriately authorized or required.
- The representative understands that competent representation includes knowing when **not** to proceed.

14. KNOWLEDGE, CONTINUING EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Maintaining DOJ accreditation requires continued development in immigration law and procedure. Immigration law and agency practices change frequently, and the Accredited Representative is responsible for maintaining current knowledge relevant to the services they provide.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Maintain broad and current knowledge appropriate to the organization's areas of practice.
- Complete required continuing immigration legal education.
- Maintain documentation verifying completed trainings.
- Complete at least the minimum training required by DOJ/EOIR for accreditation renewal.
- Ensure annual training includes required ethics or professional-responsibility education.
- Monitor significant changes to immigration law, forms, filing fees, filing procedures, agency policy, and organizational practice areas.
- Participate in formal immigration-law trainings, webinars, conferences, or courses relevant to assigned responsibilities.
- Review trusted legal resources when laws or procedures change.

- Identify areas where additional training is needed based on caseload or observed performance.
- Share important legal or procedural developments with appropriate staff.
- Maintain documentation necessary to support accreditation renewal.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- The representative's advice reflects current law and procedure rather than outdated institutional knowledge.
- Required training is completed throughout the accreditation period rather than rushed immediately before renewal.
- Verifiable records of training are maintained.
- Changes affecting office workflows are communicated and incorporated into practice.
- The representative can identify both areas of established competence and areas where additional education or consultation is required.

15. QUALITY CONTROL & CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

The Accredited Representative contributes not only to individual case quality but also to the improvement of the organization's legal-services systems.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Identify recurring mistakes, inefficiencies, and procedural weaknesses.
- Recommend improvements to checklists, questionnaires, templates, case-management processes, and staff workflows.
- Help maintain standardized procedures for common case types.
- Participate in periodic case-file review or quality assurance processes.
- Identify patterns in RFEs, rejections, denials, client confusion, or internal errors that suggest a need for process improvement.
- Ensure templates and internal resources are updated when law or agency procedure changes.
- Encourage a culture in which errors are identified and corrected rather than hidden.
- Participate in the development and training of legal staff.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- Lessons learned from one case improve future cases.
- Recurring problems decrease over time.
- Staff use increasingly consistent and reliable workflows.
- Internal resources remain current and useful.
- Quality control occurs before submission, not primarily after a government agency identifies a problem.

16. ORGANIZATIONAL COMPLIANCE & DOJ RECOGNITION/ACCREDITATION RESPONSIBILITIES

The Accredited Representative shares responsibility for protecting Immigrant Connection PDX's ability to provide immigration legal services as a DOJ Recognized Organization.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Maintain active accreditation as required for assigned responsibilities.
- Practice immigration law only through organizations and locations for which the representative is properly authorized.
- Immediately notify organizational leadership of circumstances that may materially affect continued eligibility, accreditation, character and fitness, or ability to perform the role.
- Assist the organization in maintaining records needed for recognition and accreditation renewal.
- Accurately record immigration legal services performed when needed for organizational reporting.
- Cooperate with requests for information necessary to document training, experience, caseload, representation, or organizational compliance.
- Follow organizational fee schedules, fee-waiver/reduction policies, Client Service Agreements, and approved service procedures.
- Ensure services are offered only within organizationally approved areas of practice.
- Properly identify the organization and the representative's role when providing immigration legal services.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- Accreditation and organizational recognition requirements are treated as ongoing responsibilities rather than paperwork addressed only at renewal.
- Required documentation is readily available when renewal or reporting occurs.
- The representative consistently practices within authorized organizational and regulatory boundaries.
- Organizational leadership is promptly informed of circumstances that could affect accreditation or compliance.

17. MISSION, PROFESSIONALISM & CLIENT-CENTERED SERVICE

Immigrant Connection PDX serves individuals and families who may be navigating complex legal systems, financial limitations, language barriers, cultural differences, trauma, or significant uncertainty regarding their future. The Accredited Representative is expected to combine professional competence with dignity and compassionate service.

Responsibilities

The Accredited Representative will:

- Treat every client with dignity and respect regardless of nationality, immigration status, economic circumstances, language, education, faith, or background.
- Demonstrate patience when clients struggle to understand processes or gather required information.
- Communicate requirements clearly without unnecessarily shaming or intimidating clients.
- Maintain appropriate boundaries while showing genuine compassion.
- Recognize the power imbalance that may exist between legal-service providers and vulnerable clients.
- Represent Immigrant Connection PDX's mission and values through professional conduct.
- Seek to provide excellent legal service without treating clients as case numbers or merely forms to be completed.

Success in this responsibility looks like:

- Clients experience both professional competence and genuine respect.
- Compassion does not replace legal accuracy, and legal accuracy does not eliminate compassion.
- Staff and clients experience the representative as patient, trustworthy, clear, and professional.
- The representative's conduct strengthens confidence in Immigrant Connection PDX.

QUALIFICATIONS

The DOJ Accredited Representative should demonstrate:

Required

- Current DOJ accreditation through Immigrant Connection PDX.
- Strong analytical reasoning skills, including the ability to identify patterns, work through complex fact scenarios, and genuinely enjoy logic-puzzle-style problem solving.
- Highly detail-oriented, with the ability to recognize inconsistencies, missing information, procedural requirements, and potential legal concerns.
- Ability to work well with people from diverse cultural, linguistic, educational, and socioeconomic backgrounds.
- A strong sense of justice and commitment to helping clients navigate complex immigration systems with dignity, fairness, and integrity.
- Ability to advocate effectively for clients while also communicating professionally and constructively with USCIS, DHS, EOIR, and other government agencies within the scope of accreditation.
- Ability to function effectively in a fast-paced, emotionally charged office environment where client circumstances may involve significant stress, uncertainty, fear, urgency, or disappointment.
- Strong self-differentiation skills, including the ability to remain calm, thoughtful, emotionally grounded, and professionally responsible while working with distressed clients, interpersonal tension, disagreement, or high-pressure situations.

- Ability to function effectively in a highly fluid and rapidly changing legal and procedural landscape.
- A genuine love of learning and willingness to continually study new immigration law, regulations, policies, procedures, and agency practices.
- High adaptability and flexibility, including the ability to make appropriate changes in the moment when new information, changing circumstances, government actions, or client needs require a different approach.
- Sound professional judgment and the ability to distinguish between matters that can be handled independently and those requiring additional research, consultation, supervision, or referral.
- Strong written and verbal communication skills, including the ability to explain complicated legal concepts in clear and understandable language.
- Strong organizational and case-management skills, with the ability to manage multiple legal matters, deadlines, appointments, and competing priorities simultaneously.
- Ability to maintain strict confidentiality and exercise appropriate professional boundaries.
- Ability to recognize the limits of personal knowledge and competence and seek qualified assistance rather than guessing or proceeding beyond one's ability.
- Commitment to ethical immigration legal practice and to providing accurate, competent, compassionate, and client-centered representation.
- Ability to learn and adapt as immigration law and procedures change.

Strongly Preferred

- Prior experience within a DOJ Recognized Organization, nonprofit immigration legal-services program, immigration law office, or similar setting.
- Experience conducting immigration consultations.
- Experience preparing and reviewing USCIS filings.
- Experience supervising or training legal support staff.
- Experience with immigration case-management software.
- Bilingual or multilingual ability relevant to the organization's client population.
- Formal training in immigration law and procedure beyond minimum accreditation requirements.

SCOPE OF AUTHORITY

The Accredited Representative is authorized to provide immigration legal services only:

1. Within the scope of their current DOJ accreditation through Immigrant Connection PDX.
2. Within areas of practice approved by Immigrant Connection PDX.
3. Within areas in which the representative possesses sufficient knowledge and competence; and
4. In accordance with applicable law, regulations, professional conduct requirements, and organizational policy.

A representative's accreditation should never be interpreted as requiring them to accept or independently handle every immigration matter.

When a matter exceeds the representative's accreditation, organizational scope, experience, or competence, the representative is expected to consult with Immigration Connection Nationals' technical legal support to discern if a case should be taken or not.

ROLE DISTINCTION: ACCREDITED REPRESENTATIVE VS. LEGAL ASSISTANT

The Accredited Representative and Legal Assistant work collaboratively but hold fundamentally different responsibilities.

The Legal Assistant primarily prepares, organizes, gathers, verifies, and supports.

The Accredited Representative analyzes, advises, decides, reviews, represents, and assumes responsibility for the legal matter.

Accordingly:

- A Legal Assistant may gather facts; the Accredited Representative determines their legal significance.
- A Legal Assistant may prepare forms; the Accredited Representative determines whether the filing is legally appropriate and approves the final legal work.
- A Legal Assistant may identify inconsistencies; the Accredited Representative evaluates their legal consequences.
- A Legal Assistant may prepare documents for a consultation or signing; the Accredited Representative provides legal advice and answers substantive legal questions.
- A Legal Assistant may track routine case tasks; the Accredited Representative owns the overall legal strategy and progression of the case.
- A Legal Assistant may communicate administrative information; the Accredited Representative provides individualized legal advice.
- A Legal Assistant works under authorized legal supervision; the Accredited Representative carries professional responsibility for the legal services performed under their direction.

Delegation therefore does not eliminate the Accredited Representative's responsibility to provide adequate supervision and meaningful review.

CORE PERFORMANCE STANDARD

The central expectation of the DOJ Accredited Representative position is competent ownership of assigned legal matters. Success is not measured simply by the number of applications filed or clients served. Successful performance means that the representative:

- Understands the client's legal situation.
- Identifies significant facts and legal issues.
- Provides accurate and understandable legal advice.
- Develops an appropriate strategy.

- Anticipates foreseeable problems.
- Keeps cases moving.
- Supervises delegated work appropriately.
- Produces high-quality filings.
- Meets deadlines.
- Communicates with clients.
- Maintains accurate case records.
- Practices within their competence and accreditation.
- Seeks assistance when necessary.
- Continues developing professionally.
- Protects the client, the organization, and the integrity of the legal process.

The representative should increasingly pursue supervision on genuinely complex or unusual legal nuances - not of routine responsibilities that fall within the expected competence of the position.

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

I acknowledge that I have received, read, and understand this Department of Justice Accredited Representative Position Description.

I understand that my responsibilities include legal analysis, client counseling, case strategy, review and supervision of case preparation, representation within the scope of my accreditation, ethical compliance, case management, continuing education, and protection of client interests.

I understand that DOJ accreditation authorizes immigration legal practice only within the scope of my accreditation and through an appropriately DOJ Recognized Organization. I further understand that maintaining accreditation does not eliminate my responsibility to recognize the limits of my individual competence and to seek consultation, supervision, transfer, or referral when appropriate.

I understand that this Position Description describes the general duties and expectations of the position and that responsibilities may reasonably change according to organizational needs, changes in immigration law or procedure, DOJ/EOIR requirements, and the development of Immigrant Connection PDX's legal-services program.

Employee/Representative Printed Name: _____

Employee/Representative Signature: _____

Date: _____

Supervisor Printed Name: _____

Supervisor Signature: _____

Date: _____